

Michal Hornicky

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER · AGENT INFRASTRUCTURE · ML SYSTEMS

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About Me

Right now I'm focused on one problem: recursive self-improvement isn't a model problem — it's an environment problem, the tooling and harness and whole ecosystem around the model. I can't train a frontier model alone; what I can build is the self-improving developer environments that drive those models to their maximum effectiveness — at Google DeepMind on the Gemini team by day, on a fleet of autonomous-agent systems by night, where the engineering process generates the data that improves first the harness, then the model. I'm goal-oriented and prioritize developer velocity; my process is built on fast idea exploration — prototypes, design docs, and collaborative discussion. Ten years across ML systems, distributed infrastructure, and large-scale applications. I ship self-modifying agents gated, sandboxed, and fully auditable — because I think that's the only responsible way to build them.

Skills

Agent Systems	Autonomous coding agents, Multi-agent orchestration, Self-improving loops, LLM harness design, Tool calling, MCP protocol
ML / AI	PyTorch, MLX, Training pipelines, Distributed training, Reinforcement learning, Transformer architectures, Autodiff
Systems	Distributed systems, HPC, GPGPU (CUDA/OpenCL), ML Accelerators, Hermetic builds (Buck2/Bazel), Sandboxing, Actor models
Infrastructure	Kubernetes, Terraform, Large-scale data processing, Observability, CI/CD, GCP
Languages	Python, Rust, Go, C/C++, Swift, Kotlin, TypeScript
Spoken	Slovak (Native), Czech (Native), English (Fluent), German (Beginner)

Work Experience

Senior Software Engineer — Gemini / Google DeepMind

Zurich

GOOGLE

Nov 2024 – Present

- Lead a small team building agent-native developer infrastructure for the Gemini organization — fleets of collaborating agents that take over significant parts of the engineering loop: planning, implementation, and review
- Pioneered agent integration across the Gemini application stack: multi-agent orchestration, tool-augmented workflows, and the internal best practices around them
- Drive adoption through tooling and workshops — the function is researcher and engineer velocity: make the people around me faster by giving them better machinery
- Implemented core product features in the Gemini mobile application

Software Engineer — Assistant & Gemini

Zurich

GOOGLE

Nov 2021 – Nov 2024

- Developed automated testing architecture and tooling for Android and iOS applications at scale
- Supported testing and releases for Google Assistant, Search, and Gemini/Bard mobile apps
- Pioneered use of LLMs for automated testing and software verification, building early internal tools for AI-assisted development

Senior Software Engineer / Team Lead

Brno

RED HAT

Jul 2020 – Sep 2021

- Led a team of 5 engineers building the Patch application on cloud.redhat.com
- Engineered a custom database and evaluation engine for RHEL package dependency resolution, overcoming PostgreSQL performance limits — required novel algorithmic approaches to graph traversal at scale
- Scaled the platform to serve thousands of large-scale RHEL fleet deployments daily

Software Engineer

Brno

RED HAT

Sep 2019 – Jul 2020

- Initiated development of the Patch application; built Go libraries for integrating into Python ecosystem

- Full lifecycle management of 10+ B2B Android applications; led architectural modernization to Kotlin, MVVM, reactive dataflow

Independent Projects

Bedrock — AI-Native Software Company in a Box

AUTONOMOUS AGENTS THAT BUILD, REVIEW, AND IMPROVE THE PLATFORM ITSELF

2026 – Present

- An AI-native software company in a box: autonomous agents build, review, and deploy changes to the platform itself — fully autonomous, end to end
- Engineered to generate its own data (every change, dispatch, agent conversation, and review is a logged trajectory) and reflexively improve itself from that data and from the frictions and gaps it identifies in its own operation — a Voyager-style lifelong-learning loop applied to a software platform. The same trajectory data improves the harness today and is designed to feed model optimization
- Safe by construction: deny-first agent sandboxing, per-agent isolation and identity, a human gate on the trust base, and an explicitly-advisory LLM review judge

llm-lab — Exploratory LLM Training

TRAINING AND EVALUATING LANGUAGE MODELS ON APPLE SILICON

 SEMTEXZV/LLM-LAB

2025 – Present

- Complete 150M-parameter training/evaluation pipeline (MLX): custom optimizers, mixed precision, IsoFLOP comparison harness for controlled architecture comparisons
- I reimplement current frontier architectures from the papers — linear-attention variants, attention-residual schemes — to keep a working feel for what the researchers I'd support actually do

mage — Self-Recompiling Coding Agent

AN AGENT THAT EXTENDS ITSELF BY RECOMPILING ITS OWN BINARY

 SEMTEXZV/MAGE

- Embeds a snapshot of its own source; splices in new modules, recompiles a fresh binary, and hot-swaps into the next generation via a supervising monitor — self-modification at the compiled-artifact level
- Rust workspace (edition 2024): concurrent/serial tool dispatch, hierarchical cancellation, differential terminal renderer

Termineer — Autonomous AI Coding Agent

SELF-DIRECTED CODING AGENT BUILT ON A CONFIGURABLE TOOL-CALLING GRAMMAR

 SEMTEXZV/TERMINEER

- A configurable grammar unified function calling across Anthropic, Google, and OpenAI — built when providers had no shared format for it
- Autonomous task decomposition with specialized sub-agents; MCP protocol support

GenAgent — Always-On Personal Assistant

TASKBAR AI ASSISTANT (MACOS/IOS), EXPLORED ALONGSIDE TERMINEER

 SEMTEXZV/GENAGENT

- Menu-bar assistant invokable anytime for coding and general help — the personal-assistant thread, explored before and alongside Termineer's coding agent

Notable Open Source

Protokit — High-Performance Protocol Buffers for Rust

 SEMTEXZV/PROKIT

- Only Rust implementation supporting full TextFormat specification; competitive with prost; dual front-end compiler

Stor — Embedded Key-Value Database

 SEMTEXZV/STOR

- Typed key-value database on RocksDB with zero-copy deserialization; storage engine for a low-latency cryptocurrency portfolio platform

Education

Master's Degree, Information Technology

BRNO UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY

Thesis: Distributed algorithmic cryptocurrency trading system (Rust, ZeroMQ, NATS, Kubernetes)

Brno

2017 – 2019

Bachelor's Degree, Information Technology

BRNO UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY

Brno

2014 – 2017